

the last big release. Keeping up with the constantly growing demand of the masses is a challenge. And after the Oculus Rift and Virtuix Omni make themselves available in the public market, gaming will never be the same. Think back to your childhood and the enormous pull of Questworld. Even back then, gamers have wanted to stick their physical selves into a video game and transcend their experience into virtual reality. With recent advances in that field, people may actually get what they wanted two decades ago.

Some time ago, the Oculus Rift made its entry into the gaming scene (<http://dgit.in/17i7Rvn>), putting you into the game, and amping virtual reality to the next level. If you thought that was it, hold your breath. Check out the Virtuix Omni: <http://dgit.in/trulyVR>. While Oculus gets your head in



Break through reality into the virtual world

the game (pun intended), the Omni makes sure you really, really feel the pressure. The Omni consists of a platform which is specifically built to incorporate the player's feet movement in the game. Race across the battlefield, strafe corners and get a proper workout with almost perfect physical interaction with your PC and Console games.

Admittedly, not the same as plugging your head into a game and creating a three-dimensional animated avatar of yourself - but a lot more convenient, wouldn't you say?

Immortality?

Dmitry Itskov is a Russian Scientist and the head of the *2045 Initiative* - A non-profit organization researching the somewhat controversial field of life extension. With experts in the fields of robotics, neural interface and artificial organs and biological systems, Itskov and the 2045 claim that they can introduce man to a

form of immortality by 2045. They call this the 'Avatar' project.

Milestones:

- Avatar A (2015-2020): A robotic copy of a human body remotely controlled via BCI
- Avatar B (2020-2025): An Avatar in which a human brain is transplanted at the end of one's life.
- Avatar C (2030-2035): An Avatar with an artificial brain in which a human personality is transferred at the end of one's life.
- Avatar D (2045-2045): A hologram-like Avatar.

This project has faced severe criticism as well as support. While some experts feel that the concept is too erratic and a theory that has no basis in fact to be successful, a lot of people want to wait

and see what develops, saying that back in the 60s, even organ transplants were frowned on and considered impossible.

Frankly, Frankenstein may have been unsuccessful, but his theories were sound. The 2045 Initiative is at too early a stage to start judging its possible success. Looking into science fiction for advice,

admittedly, didn't seem to yield too many positive results. Metallo (The man with a kryptonite heart), Krang (the pink brain behind most attacks against Leonardo and his brothers) and Pretorius (Stanley Ipkiss' alter ego's arch nemesis) didn't instill much confidence in the project, but keeping a positive spin on all this, let's see where Itskov goes with his baby.



Viva la -bzzzt! Revolution!

One is glad to be of service.

"...and then of course I've got this terrible pain in all the diodes down my left hand side..."

"No?" said Arthur grimly as he walked along beside him. "Really?"

"Oh yes," said Marvin, "I mean I've asked for them to be replaced but no one ever listens."

Marvin the paranoid android would be quite happy (well, relatively happy) if he'd heard of EZ Robot. Existing under the assumption that robotics will always be a complex process, they claim to make it easier to put 'bots together for anyone who wants one. Their primary USP is being 'the first company to successfully make robots easy to build and integrate into your life'; a statement which seems highly accurate. If you visit the store on their website (<http://www.ez-robot.com/Shop/>) or view their promo video (<http://dgit.in/ezrobot>). One should also keep in mind that making, owning and maintaining robots isn't a cheap hobby. With robots priced at \$249-\$469 and parts at \$22-\$300, you need to be earning a decently large income.

In the larger scheme of things, it's incredible how far robotics has come; to the extent of being able to outfit one of these 'bots with a personality of your choice as well. It seems the revolution is, indeed here.

Read. Roll. Reuse.

Imagine reading a newspaper on your way to work, but instead of the cumbersome fluttering sheets that you usually read everyday it's replaced by a foldable sheet which is, in fact a portable screen broadcasting news right into your hands. Yes, I mean *that* scene from *Minority Report*. Well, it's coming close to that level of tech. The company 'Plastic Logic' manufactures plastic flexible displays that make use of e-ink technology to make your screen a pocket commodity. Link this up to your smartphone, or another portable device and read books and news on the go off the display. Of course, comparing it to the sci-fi concept may be premature, considering the display is exactly that - a display, with little or no in-built memory or operating system of its own and no connection to wireless internet of any kind. However, it's a very good start.